

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Lapse of paramountcy and the constructed Union

15 AUG 1947 -> BRITISH RULE ENDS -> paramountcy LAPSES (it is not transferred)

BRITISH INDIA -> partitioned by statute; successor dominions defined in law

PRINCELY INDIA -> no successor sovereign in law -> authority must be constructed

INSTRUMENTS USED -> agreement + leverage + popular pressure + force in one case

RULE -> lapse, not transfer; the single word that generates the whole topic.

MUST REMEMBER: Accession, administrative integration and constitutional reorganisation were distinct: Junagadh, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir followed different legal, military and political sequences.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Counting convention: why more than 560 is the safe form

CLAIM	STATUS
"more than 560"	required formulation in both repository owners
562 / 565	different classification rules for estates, jagirs, minor holdings
"over 560"	the form used on official commemorative pages
local OCR numeral	corrupted in extraction; cannot arbitrate between totals
VERDICT -> the disagreement is about enumeration conventions, not about history.	

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: The States Department as a working machine

STATES DEPARTMENT (created 27 June 1947)

|-- MINISTER -> Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Home and States Minister

|-- SECRETARY -> V.P. Menon, drafting, negotiation, administrative sequencing

|-- METHOD -> appeal to patriotism + narrow legal demand + warning of stiffer terms

`-- PRODUCT -> standardised Instruments of Accession and standstill arrangements

NAMING RULE -> minister, secretary and department together, never one man alone.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Three subjects taken, everything else left behind

TRANSFERRED AT ACCESSION	RETAINED BY THE RULER AT ACCESSION
Defence	internal administration
External Affairs	revenue and taxation inside the state
Communications	courts and internal justice
	succession, titles, ceremonial privilege

WHY IT WORKED -> the three taken were exactly the three no state could exercise alone

WHY IT LOOKED SMALL -> the ruler's visible world was untouched on the day of signature.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The accession calendar of 1947

20 FEB 1947 -> Attlee: paramountcy will not be handed to any government of British India
APR 1947 -> some states join the Constituent Assembly; others announce independence hopes
18 JUN 1947 -> Jinnah: states become independent sovereign states on termination
27 JUN 1947 -> States Department created; Patel takes charge, V.P. Menon as Secretary
15 AUG 1947 -> all states except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir, Hyderabad have acceded
READ AS -> a seven-week campaign against a legal vacuum, not a leisurely negotiation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: The prince squeezed from above and below

PRESSURE FROM ABOVE -> States Department: accede narrowly now, or face stiffer terms

PRESSURE FROM BELOW -> States' Peoples' Conference: democratic order and integration

PRESSURE FROM OUTSIDE -> Partition violence makes isolation dangerous, not sovereign

DOCTRINE AGAINST HIM -> political power belongs to the people of a state, not to the ruler

BARGAIN OFFERED -> three subjects surrendered; dignities, succession and income retained

OUTCOME -> the overwhelming majority accede without force being used at all.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Four stages, four instruments, four difficulties

1 ACCESSION -> Instrument of Accession, three subjects -> by 15 Aug 1947
2 MERGER -> merger agreements, unions, attachments -> from Dec 1947
3 DEMOCRATISATION -> elections, courts, services inside old states -> uneven and slower
4 INCORPORATION -> Constitution and single citizenship -> 26 Jan 1950
STRUCTURAL ERROR -> treating stage one as the finished process
CORRECTION -> each stage has its own instrument, its own date and its own difficulty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Junagadh settled by counting people

NAWAB accedes to Pakistan -> against population and against geography

POPULATION overwhelmingly Hindu -> popular movement -> Nawab flees

PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT formed inside the state

DEWAN Shah Nawaz Bhutto invites the Government of India to intervene

INDIAN TROOPS enter; PLEBISCITE held FEBRUARY 1948 -> result favours India

DISCIPLINE -> the source calls the result overwhelming; no percentage is asserted here.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Hyderabad: negotiation exhausted before force

PRE-AUG 1947 -> Nizam claims independent status; state landlocked inside India
NOV 1947 -> STANDSTILL AGREEMENT signed; representative government hoped for
1947-48 -> Ittihad ul Muslimin and Razakars grow; State Congress satyagraha
-> Communist-led peasant struggle continues in the Telangana region
JUN 1948 -> Patel presses for unqualified accession and responsible government
SEP 1948 -> OPERATION POLO / POLICE ACTION -> Nizam surrenders -> accedes to the Union
DISCIPLINE -> no casualty figure and no troop figure is asserted for this episode.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Kashmir: the fixed order of events

STEP 1 -> Maharaja Hari Singh accedes to neither dominion

STEP 2 -> National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah favours accession to India

STEP 3 -> OCTOBER 1947 tribal invasion advances towards Srinagar

STEP 4 -> Maharaja appeals to India for military assistance

STEP 5 -> Instrument of Accession signed; Sheikh Abdullah heads the administration

STEP 6 -> troops flown to Srinagar only AFTER accession

STEP 7 -> 30 DEC 1947 reference to the UN Security Council; fighting continues

STOP LINE -> restraint beyond step seven; contested later claims are not taught here.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: The Instrument of Accession transferred specified subjects, not an identical final settlement in every state; Hyderabad's September 1948 action and Kashmir's October 1947 accession cannot be analogised mechanically.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: The merger map of the second stage

SECOND STAGE (from December 1947) -> turning acceding units into governable provinces

|-- MERGED -> small states attached to neighbouring provinces or centrally administered

|-- UNIONS -> Madhya Bharat | Rajasthan | Patiala and East Punjab States Union

| -> Saurashtra | Travancore-Cochin

`-- RETAINED -> Mysore | Hyderabad | Jammu and Kashmir as separate states of the Union

RESULT -> a deliberately asymmetrical map that later reorganisation would revisit.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: States Ministry papers, accession instruments and regional evidence must qualify triumphalist inevitability and recognise rulers, popular movements, borders and international conflict.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Price paid, process completed, commemoration handled

- PRICE -> privy purses, titles, succession, ceremonial privilege retained by rulers
 -> not abolished during initial integration; owner dates abolition to 1971
 -> no purse amount is asserted anywhere in this package
- COMPLETION-> Constitution adopted 26 Nov 1949; in force 26 Jan 1950; single citizenship
 -> independence 15 Aug 1947 and republic 26 Jan 1950 answer different questions
- COMMEMORATION -> Ministry of Culture two-year programme from 31 Oct 2024 at the Statue of Unity
 -> PIB Backgrounder 30 Oct 2025: Rashtriya Ekta Diwas annually on 31 October
- CAUTION -> the commemorative phrase "by 15 August 1947 or shortly thereafter" compresses
 a chronology that runs to February and September 1948.